

Pushing Notifications (Effectively)

By Nitin Sahu

You probably know what Tinder is...





For those who do not know

- Tinder is a popular online dating platform that allows people to connect and meet “potential” partners.
- It was launched in 2012 and has since gained immense popularity, particularly among young adults.
- The primary feature of Tinder is **swiping**.
  Users are presented with a series of profiles, one at a time, and can swipe *right* if they are interested in the person or *left* to indicate disinterest.
- Evidently, if two users both swipe right on each other, a match is made, and they can begin talking through the app's messaging system.

★ Tinder's user interface is designed to be simple and intuitive, with a focus on visual appeal.

★ However, I am going to break down and understand how this app nudges its users to **drive engagement** and **increase stickiness.**

Monthly Active Users (MAU) ➡ **75M**

App Downloads (Android+iOS) ➡ **530M**

Market Share **~27%**

Annual Revenue **$1.794B**

Gender Ratio (M/F) ➡ **3:1**

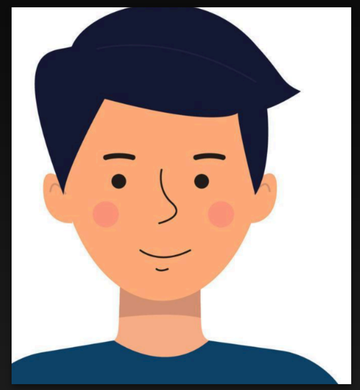
Age Range	User Spread (%)
18-24	35
25-34	25
35-44	20
45-54	8
55	10

190+ Countries

40+ Languages

4 Avg. opens/day

The two most prominent user personas



David

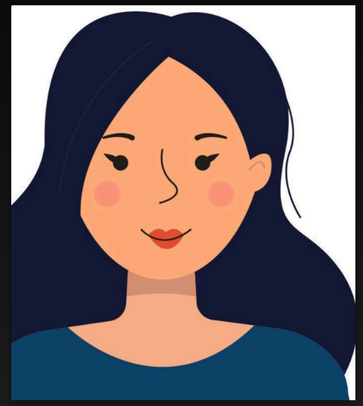
Age: 25
Occupation: Software Engineer
Archetype: The easy-going bachelor

"Anything goes - I'm not looking for anything specific. Casual or serious, I'm open to new experiences"

Goals/Needs:
- Find a serious or a casual partner
- Seek validation
- Have fun together

Motivators (by rank):
1. Curiosity
2. Boredom
3. Convenience
4. Loneliness
5. Hope

Pain Points:
- Getting catfished
- Isn't sure about how to impress someone while chatting online
- Getting bored of swiping



Lucy

Age: 30
Occupation: Restaurant Manager
Archetype: The busy bee

"My friend told me to try this app. I have zero expectations. However, it would be cool to meet someone nice."

Goals/Needs:
- Find a friend or a serious relationship
- Ease of communication
- Excitement

Motivators (by rank):
1. Loneliness
2. Curiosity
3. Convenience
4. Hope
5. Boredom

Pain Points:
- Rude people on the app
- Getting stressed
- Bad or failed dates

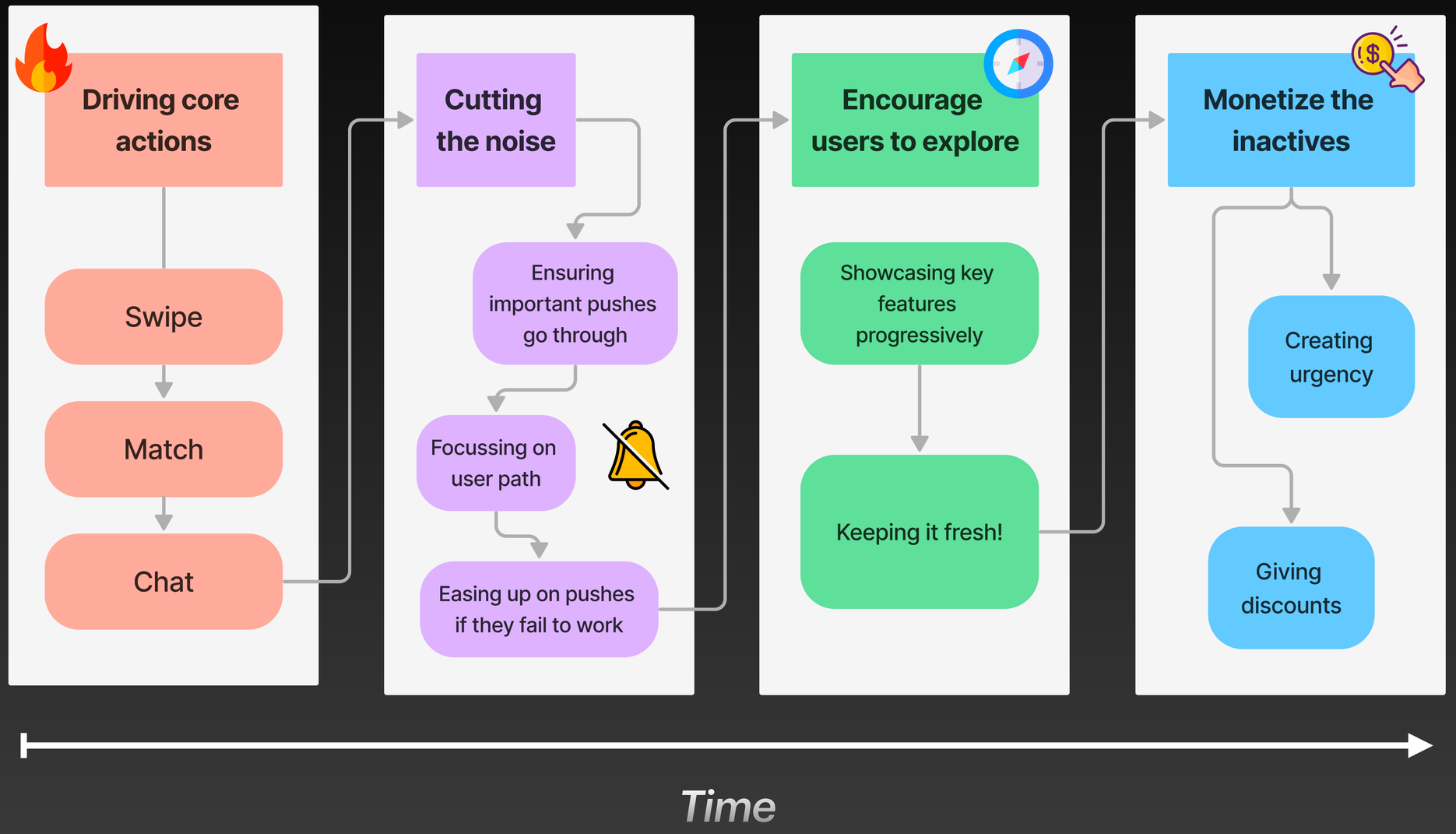
Underlying principle behind push notifications

when to push
>
what to push



Tinder capitalizes on this method of notifying their users which increases app usage and eventually lead to successful conversions.

✓ Capture the attention of user at the right moment and get them to act



Here's how the notifications look like

Driving core actions

TINDER 1m ago
Your secret admirer is not so secret anymore...👀

TINDER 1m ago
You've got a new like. ❤️ Open Tinder to find out who's waiting to talk to you.

TINDER 1m ago
Wanna be a success? You have to give likes to get likes 😉

TINDER 1m ago
Somebody likes you. 😍 Open Tinder to see who it is!

TINDER 1m ago
Your daily Top Picks are ready. 💎 Tap to view.

Getting them to chat

TINDER 1m ago
Tanya sent you a message.

TINDER 1m ago
Don't keep your match waiting. Send them a message 💌

Encouraging exploration

TINDER 1m ago
Minimalism is cool, but not when it comes to your profile - add more pics & complete your bio to get the most from your experience 🤩

✓*Two to four lines and descriptive in nature*

✓*Branded with app name and logo*

Recalling the inactives

TINDER 1m ago
Burned all your bridges and finding yourself friendless and dateless? 😔 Don't worry, there are literally millions of bridges to be destroyed on Tinder 😎😚

TINDER 1m ago
Your love affair with Netflix is completely one-sided, 💔 create a well-functioning relationship IRL and make Netflix your side-piece 🤫

Creating urgency and monetizing

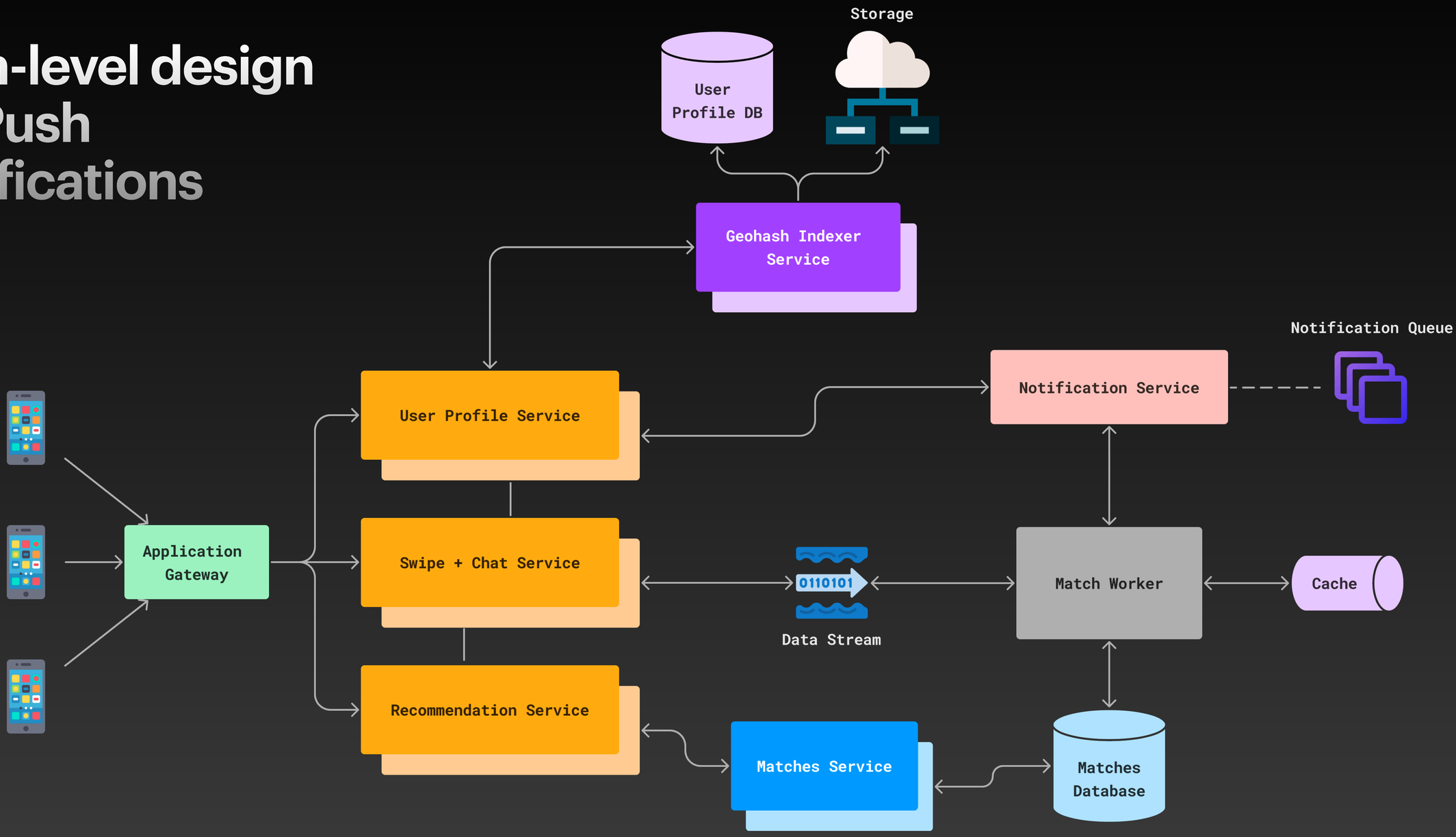
Oops! You missed a match! 1m ago
Get Gold to see who likes you.

One-liners only add to the urgency

Special offer 1m ago
ONE HOUR LEFT! ⏰ 50% off Tinder Gold!

Modified header for effective CTA

High-level design for Push Notifications



Understanding metrics using the HEART framework

(For obvious reasons ❤️)

	Goals	Metrics
Happiness	User satisfaction and happiness with the Tinder experience.	• User ratings and reviews • User surveys or feedback • Net Promotor Score (NPS)
Engagement	User engagement and activity on the platform.	• Swipes Per User • Messages Sent • Time spent per session • Active sessions per user
Adoption	Level of user adoption and commitment to the platform.	• Profile Completion Rate • New user onboarding progress • Number of connections made (in a time frame)
Retention	User retention and the ability to keep users engaged over time.	• Active Users (Daily/Weekly/Monthly) • Churn Rate • Returning user rate
Task Success	Success of critical tasks on the platform, such as matching, connections, and monetary value.	• Average Revenue Per User (ARPU) • Download-to-register % • Match success rate



Thank you for reading!